

“I appeal to the **entire population** to reserve three days to ... **pray.**”

PRESIDENT THIEU, APPEAL FOR MOURNING AFTER FALL OF PHUOC LONG, JANUARY 7, 1975

» AFTER

After its victory in Phuoc Long province, North Vietnam continued to plan its conquest of the South, envisaging a final offensive for 1976.

TAKING SAIGON

Hanoi decided to start with a local offensive in the Central Highlands. The initial blow was to fall on another poorly defended provincial capital, Buon Ma Thuot. Launched in March 1975, this attack unexpectedly precipitated a widespread **collapse of the ARVN**. The US launched a hurried **evacuation of the capital** as South Vietnam was defeated and **Saigon fell to the NVA** in April 1975.



DAUGHTER OF AN ARVN SOLDIER AWAITS EVACUATION